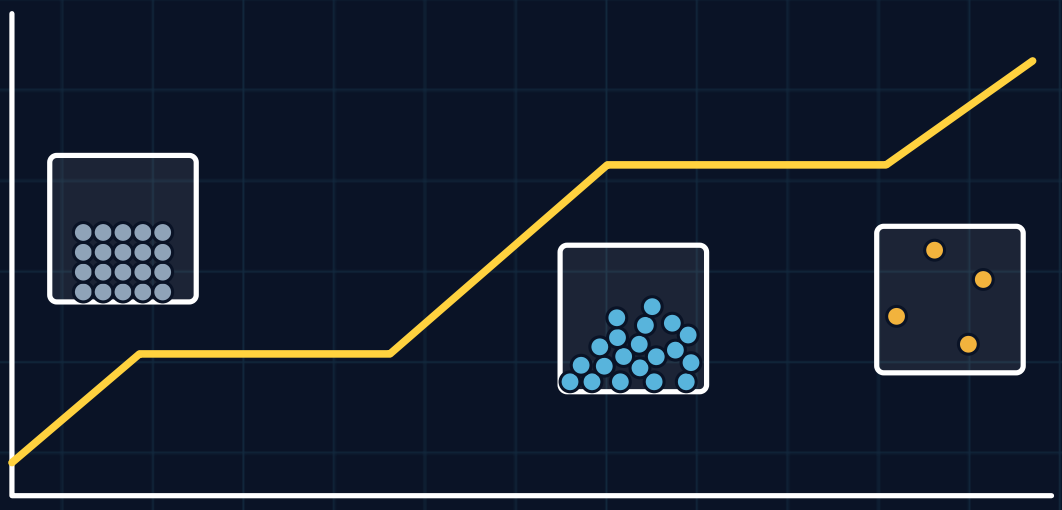
YEAR 10 PHYSICS, AQA GCSE, UNIT REVIEW

PARTICLE MODEL OF MATTER

UNIT REVIEW

AFTER LESSON 8

Mixed exam practice from the whole unit, a fix-it log, the equation toolkit, and extension pages on gas pressure and volume for GCSE Physics (Triple Science) students.



NAME _____ CLASS _____

TEACHER _____ TARGET GRADE _____

REFERENCE

EQUATION TOOLKIT

Every equation in the unit. AQA prints all of them on the equation sheet in the exam, but you still need to know what each symbol means, its unit, and how to use it.

1. Cover the quantity you want to find.
2. What is left side by side? **Multiply**.
3. One above the other? **Divide** the top by the bottom.

Example: to find V from $\rho = \frac{m}{V}$, cover V. m is above ρ, so $V = \frac{m}{\rho}$.

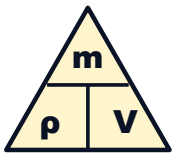
$\rho = \frac{m}{V}$

Lesson 3

density = mass ÷ volume

kg/m³, kg, m³ (or g/cm³, g, cm³)

$m = \rho V$ and $V = \frac{m}{\rho}$



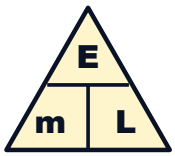
$E = m L$

Lesson 6

energy for a change of state = mass × specific latent heat

J, kg, J/kg

$L = \frac{E}{m}$ and $m = \frac{E}{L}$



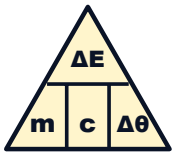
$\Delta E = m c \Delta\theta$

Lesson 7

change in thermal energy = mass × specific heat capacity × temperature change

J, kg, J/kg °C, °C

$c = \frac{\Delta E}{m \Delta\theta}$ and $\Delta\theta = \frac{\Delta E}{m c}$



$E = V I t$

Lesson 8

energy supplied = potential difference × current × time

J, V, A, s

From $P = V I$ and $E = P t$ (Electric Circuits)

$p V = \text{constant}$

Triple only

pressure × volume = constant, for a fixed mass of gas at constant temperature

Pa, m³

Use it as $p_1 V_1 = p_2 V_2$

1

Write what you know. Convert first: g → kg, cm³ → m³, kJ → J, min → s.

2

Write the equation in symbols.

3

Rearrange if you need to, then substitute the numbers.

4

Give the answer with a unit. Ask: is it sensible?

AFTER LESSON 8, AT HOME OR IN CLASS

UNIT REVIEW

Mixed questions from the whole unit, like a real exam. Try each question without looking back. The equation toolkit is on the page before this one. Then mark your answers with the answer edition and fill in the “fix it” log.

AQA-STYLE

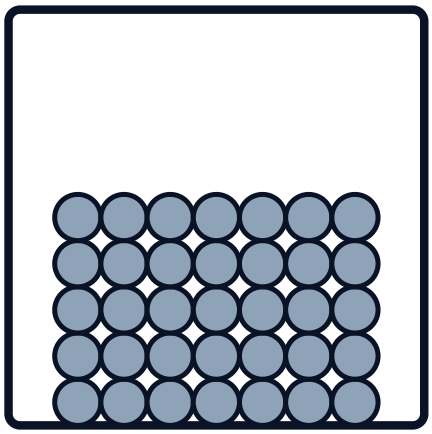
MIXED EXAM PRACTICE

39 marks, about 45 minutes

1 Draw **one** line from each state of matter to the description of its particles. **[3 marks]**

solid	far apart, moving quickly in all directions
liquid	close together in a regular pattern, vibrating
gas	close together, moving past each other

2 The box shows the particles in a solid. In the empty box, draw the particles of the same substance as a **liquid**. **[2 marks]**



3 A sealed flask contains 200 g of ice. The ice melts. **[2 marks]**

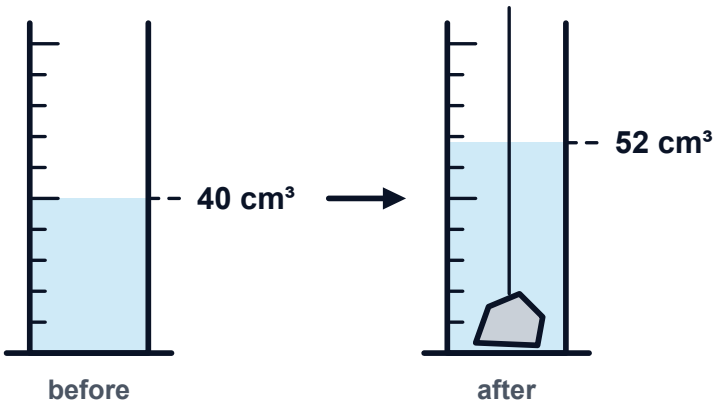
(a) State the mass of the water in the flask.

(b) Explain your answer.

4 The density of aluminium is 2700 kg/m³. Calculate the mass of an aluminium block of volume 0.040 m³. **[3 marks]**

EQUATION	
REARRANGE	
SUBSTITUTE	
ANSWER	unit:

5 A student measures the density of a metal bolt. The bolt has a mass of 93.6 g. The student lowers it into a measuring cylinder of water. **[5 marks]**



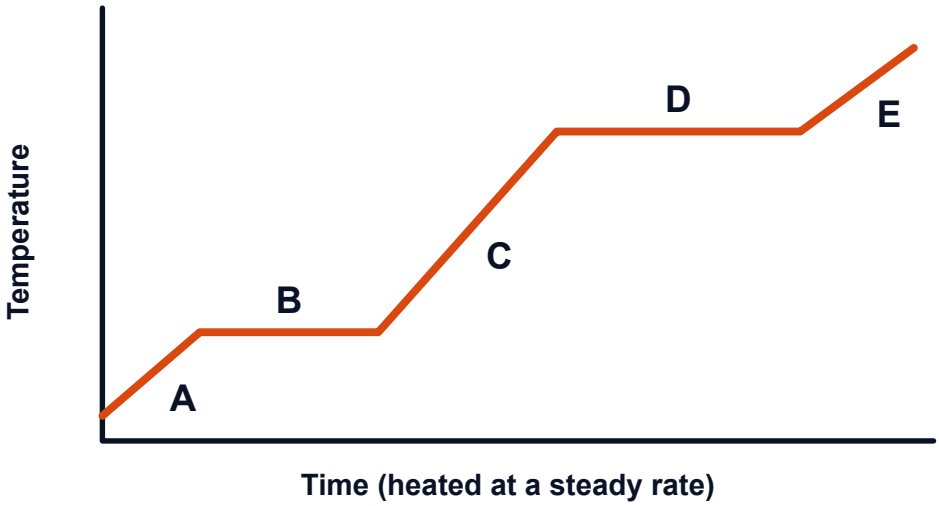
(a) Calculate the density of the bolt in g/cm³.

VOLUME	
EQUATION	
SUBSTITUTE	
ANSWER	unit:

(b) The student reads the top of the meniscus both times instead of the bottom. Explain how this affects the volume of the bolt that the student calculates.

6 A sealed metal can of air is heated. Explain, in terms of particles, what happens to the pressure of the air. **[3 marks]**

7 A solid is heated at a steady rate. The graph shows how its temperature changes. **[4 marks]**



(a) Which section shows the substance boiling?

A	B	C	D	E

(b) Explain why the temperature does not change during section B, even though the substance is still being heated.

8 State what is meant by the internal energy of a system. **[2 marks]**

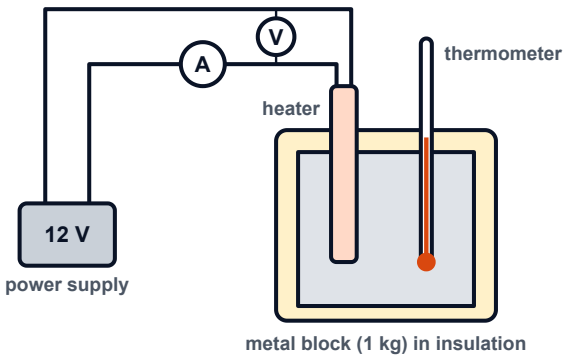
9 Calculate the energy needed to melt 0.25 kg of ice at 0 °C. Specific latent heat of fusion of water = 334 000 J/kg **[2 marks]**

EQUATION	
SUBSTITUTE	
ANSWER	unit:

10 500 g of water is heated from 20 °C to 60 °C. Calculate the energy transferred to the water. Specific heat capacity of water = 4200 J/kg °C **[4 marks]**

CONVERT	
TEMPERATURE CHANGE	
EQUATION	
SUBSTITUTE	
ANSWER	unit:

11 A student measures the specific heat capacity of a 1.0 kg iron block with an immersion heater. **[7 marks]**



(a) The heater runs at 12 V and 3.0 A for 300 s. Calculate the energy supplied. Use $E = V I t$

EQUATION	
SUBSTITUTE	
ANSWER	unit:

(b) The temperature of the block rises by 20 °C. Calculate the specific heat capacity of iron given by these results.

EQUATION	
REARRANGE	
SUBSTITUTE	
ANSWER	unit:

(c) The accepted value is 450 J/kg °C. Explain why the student's value is higher, and suggest one improvement.

12 Give one similarity and one difference between specific heat capacity and specific latent heat. **[2 marks]**

REVIEW LATER

FIX-IT LOG

Turn every lost mark into a target.

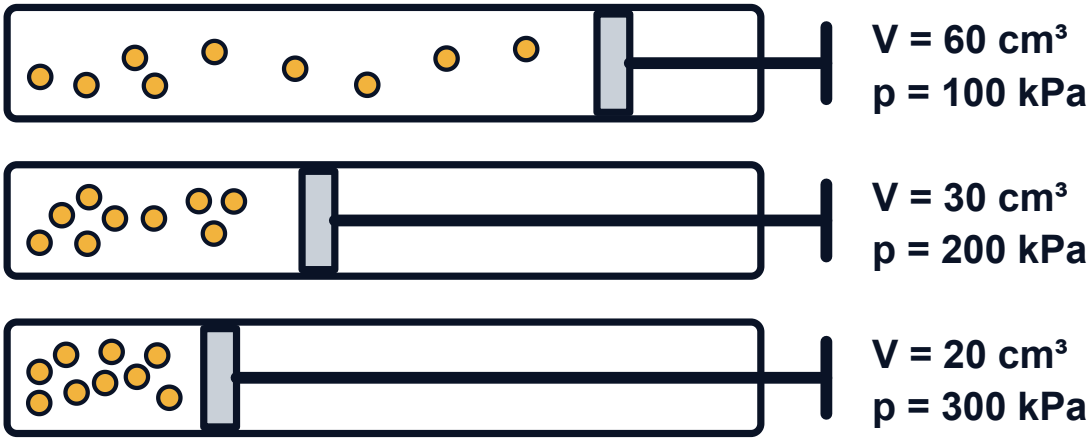
Q	What went wrong?	The correct physics (or method) is…	Lesson to revisit

PRESSURE AND VOLUME TRIPLE ONLY

Only for students taking GCSE Physics (Triple Science). Combined Science students can skip these pages.

A gas can be **compressed** (squashed) or allowed to **expand** by changing the pressure on it. The pressure of a gas produces a net force **at right angles** to the wall of its container, or to any surface in the gas.

SQUASHING A GAS AT CONSTANT TEMPERATURE



The same trapped gas, squashed slowly so that its temperature stays the same

The temperature is constant, so the molecules move at the same average speed. In a **smaller** volume they are closer together, so they hit each square centimetre of wall **more often**: the pressure is bigger. In a **bigger** volume the molecules are more spread out and hit the walls less often: the pressure is smaller.

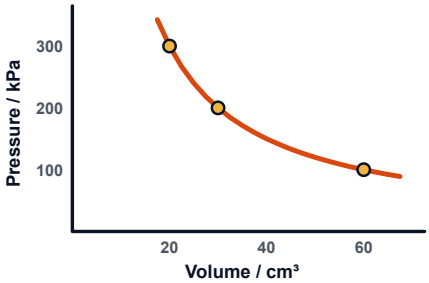
$$pV = \text{constant}$$

pressure × volume = constant

p in Pa, V in m³. For a fixed mass of gas at constant temperature.

Use it as $p_1 V_1 = p_2 V_2$: before and after. Any units will do if they are the same on both sides.

Halve the volume and the pressure doubles. Three times the volume gives a third of the pressure. Pressure is **inversely proportional** to volume, so a graph of pressure against volume is a curve.



WORKED EXAMPLE	YOUR TURN
A gas has a volume of 60 cm³ at a pressure of 100 kPa. It is squashed to 20 cm³ at constant temperature. Calculate the new pressure.	**A gas has a volume of 0.50 m³ at a pressure of 200 kPa. It expands to 2.0 m³ at constant temperature. Calculate the new pressure.**
KNOW $p_1 = 100$ kPa, $V_1 = 60$ cm³, $V_2 = 20$ cm³	KNOW
EQUATION $p_1 V_1 = p_2 V_2$	EQUATION
REARRANGE $p_2 = \frac{p_1 V_1}{V_2}$	REARRANGE
SUBSTITUTE $p_2 = \frac{100 \times 60}{20}$	SUBSTITUTE
ANSWER $p_2 = 300$ **kPa**	ANSWER

PRACTISE

CHECK IT

Answers are in the answer edition.

1 Draw a ring around the correct answer in each box.

The force that a gas exerts on a wall acts

along the wall	**at right angles to the wall**	**in a random direction**

A gas expands at constant temperature. Its pressure

increases	**decreases**	**stays the same**

2 A diver's air bubble has a volume of 12 cm³ where the pressure is 300 kPa. It rises to the surface, where the pressure is 100 kPa. Calculate its volume at the surface. Assume the temperature is constant. **[3 marks]**

EQUATION	
REARRANGE	
SUBSTITUTE	
ANSWER	unit:

3 Explain, in terms of particles, why the pressure of a gas decreases when its volume is increased at constant temperature. **[3 marks]**

TRIPLE SCIENCE ONLY (AQA PHYSICS 4.3.3.3)

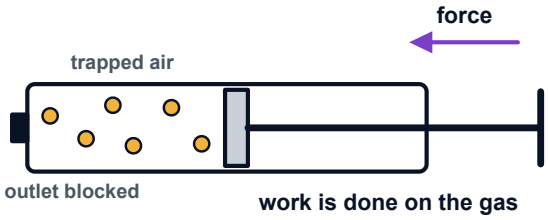
DOING WORK ON A GAS TRIPLE ONLY

Only for students taking GCSE Physics (Triple Science).

> ! **Work** is the transfer of energy by a force. Doing work on a gas increases the **internal energy** of the gas, and can cause its temperature to increase.

Block the outlet of a bicycle pump and push the handle in quickly. The pump gets warm.

1. Your force moves the piston, so you do **work** on the trapped air.
2. Energy is transferred to the air: its **internal energy** increases.
3. The molecules bounce off the moving piston faster than they arrived, so their average kinetic energy increases.
4. The **temperature** of the air rises.



Get the marks: The air heats up when it is squashed **quickly**, because the energy has no time to escape. On the pages before this one, the gas was squashed slowly, so it stayed at the temperature of the room.

PRACTISE

CHECK IT

Answers are in the answer edition.

1 Complete the sentences.

Work is the transfer of _____ **(energy / force / pressure)** by a _____ **(force / current / temperature)**.

When work is done on a gas, its internal energy _____ **(increases / decreases / stays the same)**.

2 A cyclist pumps up a tyre. Explain why the end of the pump becomes warm. **[3 marks]**

REFERENCE

KEY WORDS

Learn the meaning and the spelling. In exams, precise words earn marks: say “the particles vibrate about fixed positions”, not “the particles shake”.

Particle model L1: The idea that all matter is made of tiny particles, whose arrangement and motion explain how solids, liquids and gases behave

Change of state L1: Melting, freezing, boiling, evaporating, condensing or sublimating

Sublimating L1: Changing straight from a solid to a gas

Physical change L1: A change in which no new substance is made; the material recovers its original properties if the change is reversed

Conserved L1: Staying the same in total: mass is conserved in a change of state

Random motion L2: Movement in all directions, at a range of speeds

Gas pressure L2: The force on each square metre of a surface, caused by gas molecules colliding with it

Density (ρ) L3: The mass of each unit of volume, in kg/m³ or g/cm³

Volume L3: The amount of space something takes up, in m³ or cm³

Displacement L4: Finding the volume of an object from the volume of water it pushes out of the way

Meniscus L4: The curved surface of a liquid in a tube; read the bottom of it

Resolution L4: The smallest change in a quantity that an instrument can show

Internal energy L5: The total kinetic energy and potential energy of all the particles that make up a system

Melting point L5: The temperature at which a substance changes between solid and liquid

Boiling point L5: The temperature at which a substance boils, or condenses

Latent heat L6: The energy needed for a substance to change state, with no change in temperature

Specific latent heat (L) L6: The energy needed to change the state of 1 kg of a substance with no change in temperature, in J/kg

Fusion L6: Melting: the change from solid to liquid

Vaporisation L6: The change from liquid to vapour

Specific heat capacity (c) L7: The energy needed to raise the temperature of 1 kg of a substance by 1 °C, in J/kg °C

Temperature change (Δθ) L7: Final temperature minus starting temperature, in °C

Joulemeter L8: A meter that measures the energy supplied to an electrical appliance

Insulation L8: Material that reduces energy transfer to the surroundings

Pascal (Pa) Triple: The unit of pressure: 1 Pa = 1 N/m²

Work Triple: The transfer of energy by a force

FINISH

PROGRESS TRACKER

Colour one circle for each statement: **red** = not yet, **amber** = getting there, **green** = I can do this without help. Revisit your reds first.

I CAN…	R / A / G
01: Solids, liquids and gases	
draw and recognise particle diagrams for a solid, a liquid and a gas	🔴 🟡 🟢
describe the arrangement and motion of the particles in each state	🔴 🟡 🟢
name the changes of state	🔴 🟡 🟢
explain why mass is conserved in a change of state	🔴 🟡 🟢
explain why a change of state is a physical change	🔴 🟡 🟢
02: Gas particles and pressure	
describe the random motion of gas molecules	🔴 🟡 🟢
link temperature to the average kinetic energy of the molecules	🔴 🟡 🟢
explain how collisions with the walls cause pressure	🔴 🟡 🟢
explain why heating a gas at constant volume increases its pressure	🔴 🟡 🟢
03: Density	
calculate density with $\rho = \frac{m}{V}$	🔴 🟡 🟢
use kg/m³ and g/cm³ and convert between them	🔴 🟡 🟢
rearrange the equation to find a mass or a volume	🔴 🟡 🟢
explain differences in density using the particle model	🔴 🟡 🟢
04: Measuring density (required practical)	
measure the density of a regular solid	🔴 🟡 🟢
use displacement to find the volume of an irregular solid	🔴 🟡 🟢
measure the density of a liquid	🔴 🟡 🟢
explain how to make the measurements accurate	🔴 🟡 🟢
describe the method in a 6-mark answer	🔴 🟡 🟢
05: Internal energy and heating curves	
state what internal energy is	🔴 🟡 🟢
describe what heating does to the particles	🔴 🟡 🟢

I CAN…	R / A / G
explain why the temperature is constant during a change of state	
interpret heating and cooling graphs	
06: Specific latent heat	
define specific latent heat	
calculate energy, mass or L with $E = m\,L$	
tell fusion from vaporisation	
describe how to measure the specific latent heat of fusion of water	
07: Specific heat capacity	
state what a temperature rise depends on	
define specific heat capacity	
calculate with $\Delta E = m\,c\,\Delta\theta$	
rearrange to find c or $\Delta\theta$	
choose between specific heat capacity and specific latent heat	
08: Measuring specific heat capacity (required practical)	
describe the method for measuring specific heat capacity	
calculate the energy supplied with $E = V\,I\,t$	
calculate specific heat capacity from results	
use the gradient of a temperature–energy graph	
explain why the result is too high and how to improve it	